Selection Sort Research Report

Executive Summary

Algorithm

Selection Sort

1. Get a list of unsorted elements `LIST`
2. Iterate through the list storing the current index as `CURRENT`.
3. Store the value of the `CURRENT` index in `TEMP`
   `TEMP = LIST[CURRENT]`
4. Iterate through the remaining items in the list to find the lowest value and store the index of that item as `LOWEST_IDX`
5. Move the value of the item at `LOWEST_IDX` to the item at `CURRENT`
   `LIST[CURRENT] = LIST[LOWEST_IDX]`
6. Move the value `TEMP` to the item at `LOWEST_IDX`
   `LIST[LOWEST_IDX] = TEMP`

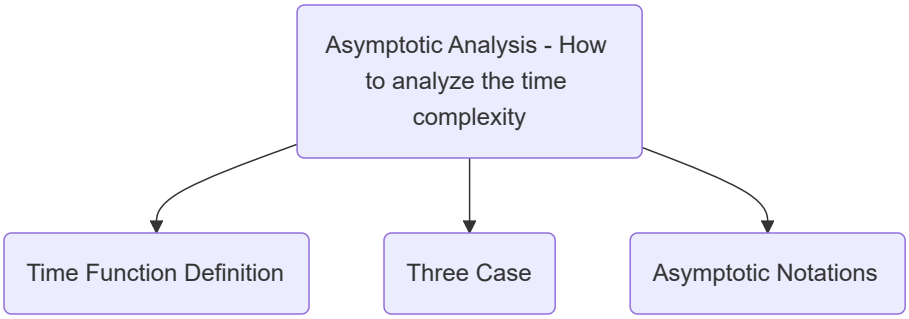
Pseudocode

```
input LIST
for CURRENT from 0 to length(LIST) do
    TEMP <- LIST[CURRENT]
    LOWEST_IDX <- CURRENT
    for SEARCH from CURRENT to length(LIST) do
        if LIST[SEARCH] < LIST[LOWEST_IDX] then
            LOWEST_IDX <- SEARCH
        endif
    endfor
    LIST[CURRENT] <- LIST[LOWEST_IDX]
    LIST[LOWEST_IDX] <- TEMP
endfor
return LIST
```

Implementation Example (Python)

```python
def selection_sort(l):
    for c in range(len(l)):
        tmp = l[c]
        lowest_idx = c
        for s in range(c, len(l)):
            if l[s] < l[lowest_idx]:
                lowest_idx = s
        l[c] = l[lowest_idx]
        l[lowest_idx] = tmp
    return l
```

Asymptotic Analysis



Time Function Definition

```
void function(int n[]) {                    // T(n)
    int i, j, tmp, lowest_idx;              // 4
    for (i = 0, i < sizeof(n), i++) {       // n + 1
        tmp = n[i]                          // n
        lowest_idx = i                      // n
        for (j = i, j < sizeof(n), j++)     // n * (n + 1)
            if n[j] < n[lowest_idx]         // n * n
                lowest_idx = j              // n * n
        l[i] = l[lowest_idx]                // n
        l[lowest_idx] = tmp                 // n
    }
}
```

$T(n) = 4 + (n+1) + n + n + (n*(n+1)) + n^2 + n^2 + n + n$

$T(n) = 3n^2 + 6n + 5$

Asymptotic Analysis Rule #1

(keeping only term with highest degree)

$T(n) = 3n^2$

Asymptotic Analysis Rule #2

(ignore constants)

$T(n) = n^2$

Three Cases

Time Function Key

$1 < log n < \sqrt{n} < n < \cdots < n^2 < n^3 < \cdots < 2^n < 3^n < \cdots < n^n$

Big O

Worst Case: Reverse Sorted List

Big O Definition

The function $f(n) = O(g(n)) \iff \exists$ two Constants C and k such that:
$f(n) <= C \cdot g(n) \quad \forall n >= k$

$n^2 <= C \cdot g(n) \quad \forall n >= 1$
$n^2 <= n^2$ where C =1 and $g(n) = n^2$

From the definition $n^2 = O(n^2)$

Big Ω

Best Case: Sorted List

Big Ω Definition

The function $f(n) = \Omega(g(n)) \iff \exists$ two Constants C and k such that:
$f(n) >= C \cdot g(n) \quad \forall n >= k$

$n^2 >= C \cdot g(n) \quad \forall n >= 1$
$n^2 >= n^2$ where C =1 and $g(n) = n^2$

From the definition $n^2 = \Omega(n^2)$

Big Θ

Average Case: Unsorted List

Big Θ Definition

The function $f(n) = \Theta(g(n)) \iff \exists$ three Constants C_1, C_2, and k such that:
$C_1 \cdot g(n) <= f(n) <= C_2 \cdot g(n) \quad \forall n >= k$

$C_1 \cdot g(n) <= n^2 <= C_2 \cdot g(n)$

$n^2 <= n^2 <= n^2 \quad \forall n >= 1$ where $C_1 = 1, C_2 = 1$ and $g(n) = n^2$

Based on the definition $n^2 = \Theta(n)$

Asymptotic Notations